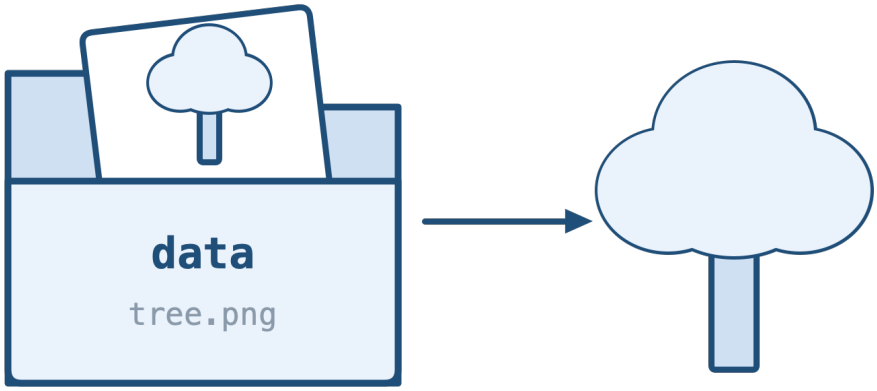
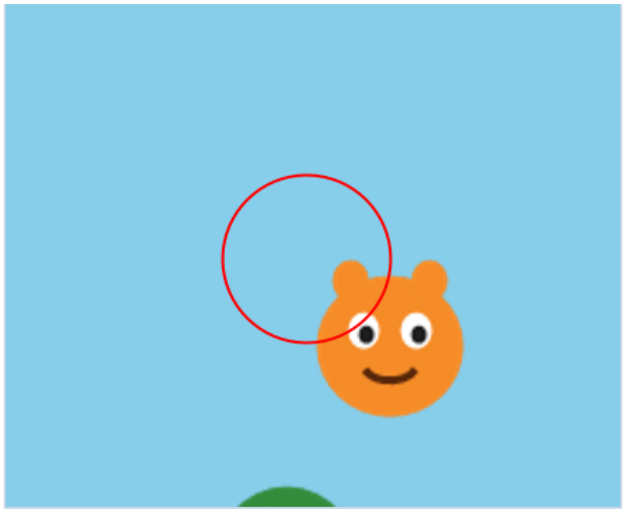
Bonus A - Images

Swap your shapes for actual pictures.



`ImageSprite`

The picture is here. The character is over there. They used to be the same place.



```
    parent.image(img, pos.x, pos.y, 60, 60);
```

So far, everything on your screen is made of shapes you drew in code: circles, rectangles, arcs. This chapter puts real pictures in your game. A character you drew in a paint program, a tree you found online, a whole background.

You can take it any time after Chapter 4. It works well between Chapters 4 and 5, or during Chapter 7, when you're making your world look finished. It takes one meeting.

This chapter does it in three moves.

Part	The idea
One	**Pictures live in a folder.** The `data` folder, and how a sketch finds a file.
Two	**Scenery: `ImageSprite`.** A sprite that's a picture.
Three	**Your character as a picture.** Keep `extends Blob`, and draw a picture in `drawSprite()`.

Today's example. Before you start, open this chapter's finished code: **File → Examples**, then **Contributed Libraries → SpriteGame → Lessons → BonusA_Images**. This one is for reading. It stops as soon as it runs, because its `data` folder is empty, and the pictures are yours to find: Processing's message says `hero.png` is missing. Read its main tab for Part Two, and its `MyImageCharacter` tab for Part Three. Your own work goes in your own sketch. Appendix 1, section A1.6, walks through opening an example one click at a time.

Ask Sparky. This lesson's Sparky opens from the button on the Bonus A page on Canvas. Good things to ask it: "my image shows up as a white box," "Processing says it cannot load my image," or "how do I make my picture the right size?" Tell it your file's name and where you put it.

Part One - Pictures live in a folder

A.1 Your picture

Your turn. Find or draw a small picture for your character. PNG is the kind of file you want. A PNG can have a **transparent** background, so the world shows through around your character. You can draw a 32-by-32 character in any paint program, or find free art at opengameart.org.

A.2 The `data` folder

Processing looks for pictures in exactly one place: a folder called `data` inside your sketch's folder.

Build it.

1. Open your sketch, and choose **Sketch → Show Sketch Folder**.
2. Make a new folder in there called `data`. Exactly that, all lowercase.
3. Drag your picture into `data`.
4. Write down its name exactly, capitals and the ending (`.png`) included.

Part Two - Scenery: `ImageSprite`

A.3 A sprite that's a picture

An **`ImageSprite`** is a sprite from the library that shows a picture. It has the sprite behaviors you know: `move()`, `setVelocity()`, `followMouse()`, `drawSprite()`. It takes the sketch, where its **center** goes, the file's name, and a size:

```
new ImageSprite(this, x, y, "tree.png")            // 100 x 100 pixels
new ImageSprite(this, x, y, "tree.png", 80)        // 80 x 80 square
new ImageSprite(this, x, y, "tree.png", 120, 80)   // 120 wide, 80 tall
```

It has no `collidesWith()`. An `ImageSprite` is a sprite, and it isn't a Blob, so it can't collide. Save it for scenery: the things in the world your player just looks at.

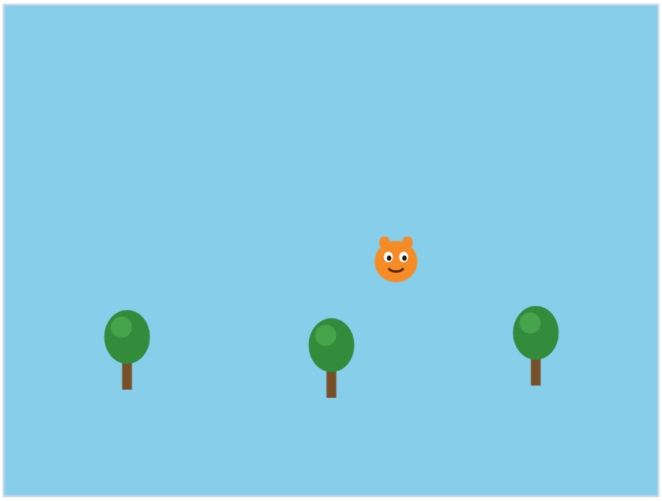
Step 1 - A picture in the world

Build it. Start with the easy one. Add an `ImageSprite` to your sketch, in the same three places as every object since Chapter 1. Here are three trees, from the Canvas page's sample sketch:

```
ImageSprite tree1;
ImageSprite tree2;
ImageSprite tree3;
  // in setup().  Replace "tree.png" with your own file name.
  tree1 = new ImageSprite(this, 150, 420, "tree.png", 60, 100);
  tree2 = new ImageSprite(this, 400, 430, "tree.png", 60, 100);
  tree3 = new ImageSprite(this, 650, 415, "tree.png", 60, 100);
  // in draw(), before your player:  decorations go behind
  tree1.drawSprite();
  tree2.drawSprite();
  tree3.drawSprite();
```

Run it.

Check. Your pictures, in your world.



Three trees, and a picture character from Part Three. The art is stand-in art. Yours is yours.

Change the size numbers until your picture looks the right shape. A tall tree squashed into a square looks wrong.

Step 2 - When the picture doesn't show

Three things go wrong here, and each one looks different.

Watch out. The name doesn't match. Ask for `"pine.png"` when the file is `tree.png`, and Processing prints this under your code, then stops:

```
The file "pine.png" is missing or inaccessible, make sure the URL is valid
or that the file has been added to your sketch and is readable.
```

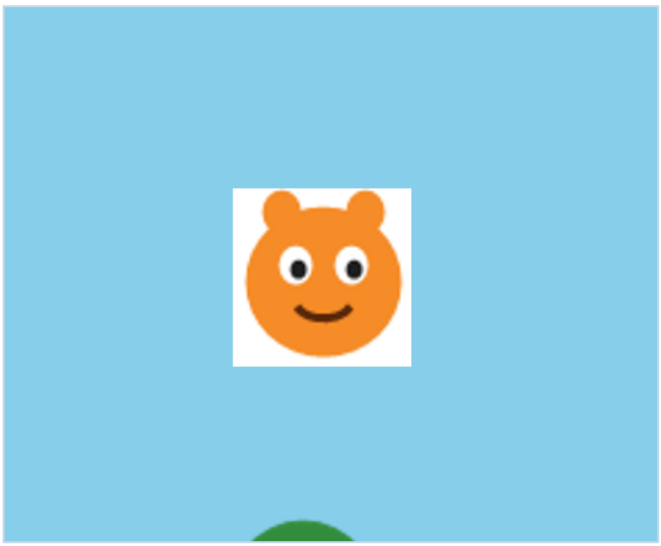
Check that the file is in `data`, and check the name letter by letter.

Watch out. The capitals don't match. Ask for `"Tree.PNG"` when the file is `tree.png`, and Processing stops and tells you exactly what's wrong:

```
This file is named tree.png not Tree.PNG. Rename the file or change your
code.
```

Capitals count here too, the same as in your code.

Watch out. A white box around your picture. The PNG was saved without a transparent background. The picture really is a rectangle, and its background just happens to be white. Your code is fine. Find or make a PNG with a transparent background. Free tools like remove.bg can take a background out for you.



The same character, saved on a white background.

Part Three - Your character as a picture

A.4 Keep the Blob

Your player needs to collide with things, and an `ImageSprite` can't. So for your character, keep `extends Blob`, exactly as you wrote it in Chapter 2, and change `drawSprite()` to draw a picture in place of shapes.

Step 3 - `MyImageCharacter`

Build it. Make a new tab called `MyImageCharacter`, and paste this in:

```
// MyImageCharacter - like MyCharacter, but draws a picture instead of shapes.
// extends Blob means it still has collidesWith() for collision detection.
class MyImageCharacter extends Blob {

  PImage img;

  MyImageCharacter(PApplet p, float x, float y, String fileName) {
    super(p, x, y, 30, color(0));  // radius 30 - the invisible collision circle
    img = p.loadImage(fileName);
  }

  void drawSprite() {
    parent.pushStyle();
    parent.imageMode(CENTER);
    parent.image(img, pos.x, pos.y, 60, 60);  // drawn centered on the sprite's
position
    parent.popStyle();
  }
}
```

Read it against your `MyCharacter` tab. The class line, the handshake, and a `drawSprite()`. Three things are new.

> **Aside: `PImage` and `loadImage()`**
>
> A **`PImage`** is Processing's kind of variable for a picture. `PImage img;` makes a box for one. `loadImage(fileName)` reads the file out of your `data` folder and puts it in the box. The constructor does that once, when the character is made. `String` is the kind of thing a piece of text is, like `"hero.png"`.

Aside: `imageMode(CENTER)`, and `pushStyle()`

`image(img, pos.x, pos.y, 60, 60)` draws the picture 60 pixels wide and 60 tall. Normally a picture is placed by its top-left corner, like a `Block`. `imageMode(CENTER)` places it by its middle, so it sits on the belly button like every other part of your character. `pushStyle()` and `popStyle()` save and put back Processing's settings around it, so `imageMode` only changes your character's drawing.

Build it. In your main tab, make your player a `MyImageCharacter` in place of a `MyCharacter`, in the declaration at the top and in `setup()`:

```
  player = new MyImageCharacter(this, width/2, height/2, "hero.png");
```

Use your own file's name. Run it, and move your character around.

Check. Your picture, moving and colliding the way your shape character did.

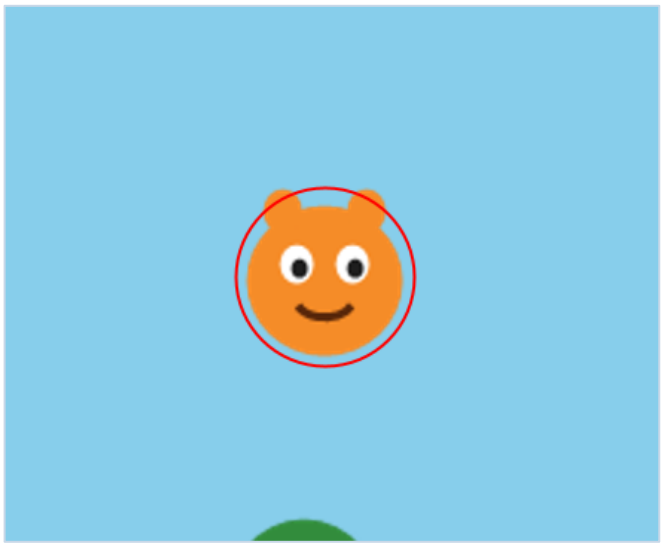
Step 4 - See your hitbox

The radius in `super(...)` is **still** your hitbox. The picture doesn't change that. So it helps to see where the hitbox is while you tune it.

Build it. At the end of `drawSprite()`, after `popStyle()`, draw the hitbox as a ring:

```
    parent.noFill();
    parent.stroke(255, 0, 0);
    parent.ellipse(pos.x, pos.y, 2 * radius, 2 * radius);   // the hitbox
```

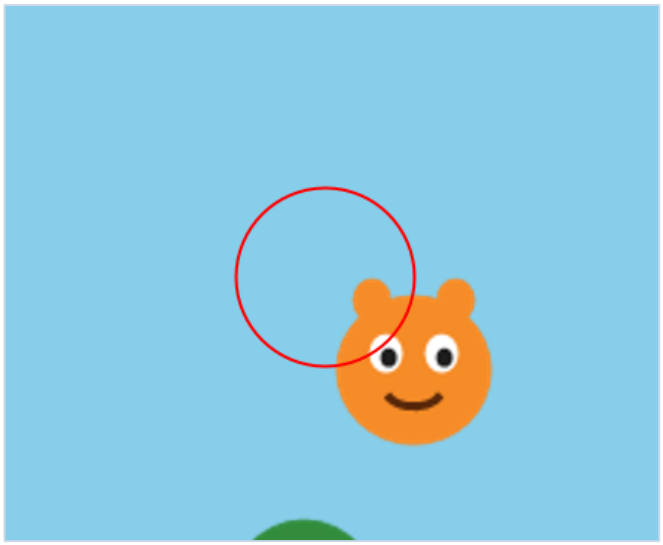
Check. A red ring around your picture. That's exactly the circle `collidesWith()` uses.



The hitbox, drawn as a ring.

Tune the `30` in `super(...)` until the ring fits. A ring slightly smaller than the picture usually feels fairest. Then take the three ring lines out before anybody else plays.

Watch out. Leave out `imageMode(CENTER)`, and the picture is placed by its corner. It sits down and to the right of your hitbox, and collisions feel broken, because they're happening where your character isn't drawn.



No `imageMode(CENTER)`. The hitbox is where the character is, and the picture is somewhere else.

Watch out. `player.collidesWith(tree1)` stops the sketch with:

```
The method collidesWith(Blob) in the type Blob is not applicable for the
arguments (ImageSprite)
```

That's Processing's way of saying a tree is an `ImageSprite`, and `collidesWith()` only works with Blobs. If your player has to touch it, make it a Blob with a picture inside, the way `MyImageCharacter` is.

The rule, side by side:

It needs to	Use
collide (your player, coins, hazards)	`extends Blob`, with a `PImage` inside
just **look nice** (trees, clouds, a background)	`ImageSprite`

A.5 Make it yours

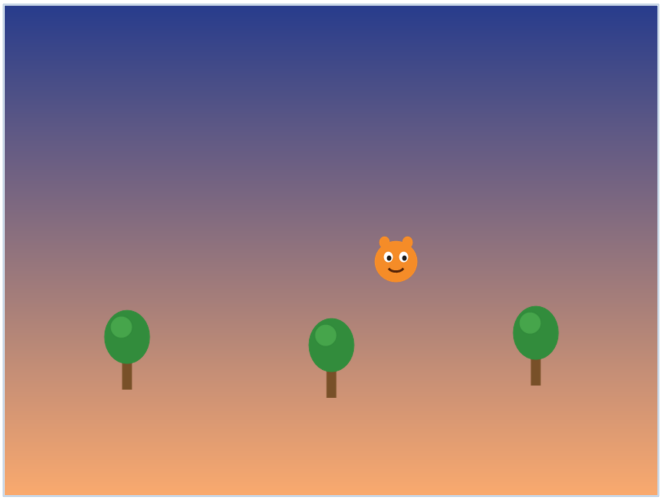
Your turn. Your own character picture. A PNG with a transparent background looks best by a mile.

Your turn. Fix the size, the `60, 60` in `image()`, so it matches your art's real shape.

Your turn. Optional: any of these.

- A **background picture**, as big as the window, drawn first in `draw()`, right after `background()`:

```
  bg = new ImageSprite(this, width/2, height/2, "background.png", width,
height);
```



A background picture, behind the trees.

- A decoration that drifts: give an `ImageSprite` a velocity, and `move()` it.
- A tilted one: `tree3.setRotation(PI/6);` tips it a little. `PI` is half a turn, so `PI/6` is a twelfth of one.
- Coins and hazards as pictures. They have to collide, so they need `extends Blob` with a picture inside, the same as `MyImageCharacter`.
- Fake an animation. Load **two** `PImage`s and swap between them every few frames. That's the whole idea behind Bonus C.

> **Watch out.** When you hand in your sketch, zip the whole folder, `data` and all. Without the `data` folder, nothing runs.

Chapter summary

You built	It's an example of
a `data` folder	where Processing looks for files
`new ImageSprite(this, x, y, "tree.png", 60, 100)`	a sprite that's a picture, for scenery
`MyImageCharacter extends Blob`	a picture inside a Blob, so it still collides
`imageMode(CENTER)`	placing a picture by its middle
the red ring	seeing your hitbox while you tune it

New syntax in this chapter

Syntax	Where you met it
`ImageSprite`	A.3, Step 1
`PImage`, `loadImage()`, `String`	Step 3
`image()`, `imageMode(CENTER)`	Step 3
`pushStyle()`, `popStyle()`	Step 3
`radius`	Step 4
`setRotation()`	A.5

Vocabulary

`data` folder -- a folder inside your sketch's folder, where Processing looks for pictures and sounds. (A.2)

`ImageSprite` -- a sprite from the library that shows a picture. It can't collide. (A.3)

`PImage` -- Processing's kind of variable for a picture. (Step 3)

transparent -- a part of a picture with no color at all, so whatever's behind it shows through. (A.1)

Check your understanding

1. Where does Processing look for your picture?
2. Why can't you use `collidesWith()` on an `ImageSprite`? What do you do when a picture has to collide?
3. Your character has a white box around it. What's wrong, and is it your code?
4. What does `imageMode(CENTER)` change?
5. Why does a picture character still need `extends Blob`?